

Windows NT no longer allowed applications to access hardware directly. To speak to hardware, they required explicit permission from the OS. Game developers had always written their games to access hardware directly, which meant that NT would not allow games to run any more.



Microsoft Word on Windows NT

In addition to all this, Microsoft also gave us the NTFS (New Technology File System) which organised data using a 'journal' or log to track changes that were made to data. The NTFS also allowed for data security, restricting users from accessing files they were not allowed to.

Even with all its new features, NT lacked decent support for new hardware, and this was its shortcoming. And because it was an operating system for enterprises, it came with very little support for sound and video devices.

All Grow'd up—Windows 95 and NT 4.0

If people had ever doubted that Windows would dominate the OS scene, Windows 95 removed that doubt. It came with better networking support, better device support, and it was better looking than any other version of Windows before it. But just like Windows 3.1 and before, it ran on MS-DOS.

The user interface for Windows 95 was its most ground-breaking aspect. The new 'Start' button gave users a one-stop solution to access programs.



The Windows 95 welcome screen